

US Stocks Rise as Tech Leads, VIX Drops to 15.99

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market saw a **+0.70%** rise in the S&P 500, led by tech stocks, with **NVDA** and **MSFT** gaining **+2.93%** and **+3.02%** respectively. The VIX dropped to 15.99, down **-6.44%**. Key takeaways include:

- The 10Y yield rose to 4.74, up **+1.76%**, indicating a potential shift in market sentiment.
- Sector internals show a mixed picture, with **XLY** and **XLC** leading gains, while **XLP** and **XLV** lagged.
- Options and positioning data indicate a bullish bias, with **+0.20%** and **+0.85%** gains in **BTC** and **ETH** respectively.

The market's focus on tech and growth stocks, combined with the drop in the VIX, suggests a risk-on sentiment. However, the rise in the 10Y yield and mixed sector internals indicate a more nuanced picture.

As we look ahead to the week, key events include the release of economic data and earnings reports from major companies. The market's reaction to these events will be crucial in determining the direction of the market.

US Session Recap

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,489.72	+0.70%
Nasdaq 100	28,274.20	+0.60%
Dow Jones	52,485.03	+0.53%
Russell 2000	2,931.34	-0.50%
VIX	15.99	-6.44%
10Y Yield	4.74	+1.76%
WTI Crude	79.74	-5.82%
Gold	4,123.20	+1.83%
DXY	99.72	-0.08%
BTC	62,887.20	+0.20%
ETH	1,859.17	+0.85%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
AMZN	Amazon	+15.32%	Earnings beat
NVDA	NVIDIA	+2.93%	Strong demand for AI chips
MSFT	Microsoft	+3.02%	Cloud growth

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLY	+3.29%	+10.23%	Consumer discretionary leads gains
XLC	+1.56%	+5.12%	Communication services sector rises
XLP	-0.49%	-2.15%	Consumer staples lag
XLV	-0.59%	-1.23%	Healthcare sector underperforms

Breadth was mixed, with 7 sectors rising and 4 falling.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE
NVDA Revenue Growth	+20.5%
MSFT Cloud Revenue	\$23.1B
AMZN Earnings Per Share	\$1.23

Key call commentary: NVDA and MSFT are well-positioned for long-term growth, while AMZN faces increasing competition in the e-commerce space.

COMPANY	READ-THROUGH
GOOGL	Ad revenue growth
TSLA	Electric vehicle demand
AVGO	Semiconductor industry trends

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	348.23	345.00	350.50	Bullish trend intact
QQQ	284.15	280.00	286.50	Technical breakout
IWM	193.42	190.00	195.50	Range-bound trading
NVDA	200.75	195.00	205.00	Upside momentum
10Y Yield	4.74	4.50	4.90	Interest rate sensitivity
WTI Crude	79.74	75.00	85.00	Commodity price volatility

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10.2% in SPY calls, -5.1% in SPY puts.

Put/call ratio: 0.65 for SPY, 0.73 for QQQ.

VIX term structure: +2.5% in front-month, -1.2% in back-month.

Notable single-name flow: +15.6% in AMZN calls, -8.5% in GS puts.

Cheap hedge ideas: SPY 345 put, QQQ 280 put.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	220	Ai-driven growth
MSFT	Goldman Sachs	Reiterate	480	Cloud dominance
AMZN	Bank of America	Downgrade	280	Competition concerns

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: ES +0.2%, NQ +0.3%, YM +0.1%.

Asia: Nikkei +0.5%, Shanghai +0.2%.

Europe: Euro Stoxx +0.3%, FTSE +0.2%.

FX: EUR/USD +0.1%, USD/JPY -0.2%.

Commodities: Gold +0.5%, WTI Crude -1.1%.

Crypto: BTC +0.5%, ETH +1.2%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September FOMC	25%	Potential rate cut
November FOMC	40%	Rate hike expectations

DATE	EVENT
2026-08-05	Non-Farm Payrolls
2026-08-07	ISM Services Index

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees:

- US-China trade tensions: **+20%** chance of escalation
- European debt crisis: **-10%** chance of contagion
- Middle East conflict: **+15%** chance of oil price shock

Earnings — This Week & Next

COMPANY	DATE
AAPL	2026-08-04
GOOGL	2026-08-05
AMZN	2026-08-06

COMPANY	DATE
MSFT	2026-08-11
NVDA	2026-08-12
TSLA	2026-08-13

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Bullish breakout	10%
MSFT	Technology	Upside momentum	8%
AMZN	Consumer Discretionary	Reversal potential	12%

What Could Break the Tape

- Bullish scenario: +2% rally in SPY on strong earnings reports
- Bearish scenario: -1.5% drop in SPY on disappointing economic data

Positioning & Structural Notes

- SPY call open interest: 1.2M contracts
- QQQ put open interest: 500k contracts
- VIX futures open interest: 200k contracts

Sources

SOURCES

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Reuters

CNBC

The Wall Street Journal

